Shades of Inclusion

A Digital Ethnography of Fenty Beauty's Brand Identity Across Platforms

STRATEGIC BRAND MANAGEMENT

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Introduction: Redefining Beauty

In 2017, Rihanna launched Fenty Beauty with **40 foundation shades** —now over 50—sending a clear signal: inclusivity and representation would be at the heart of the brand.

> "Makeup is for you to play with. It should never feel like pressure, and it should never feel like a uniform." — Fenty Beauty

This project analyzes Fenty's website, blog, and **15 recent Instagram posts** to examine how the brand communicates its inclusive mission consistently across digital platforms.

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Mission, Vision & Core Values

Foundational Mission

Fenty's mission is a manifesto challenging the beauty industry's exclusionary norms—closing the gap in products for underrepresented skin tones.

Three Core Values

- **Inclusivity** — Comprehensive shade range, gender-neutral positioning, authentic global diversity in casting
- **Playful Experimentation** — Beauty as artistic expression: "take chances... dare to do something new"
- **Accessibility & Community** — Approachable language, educational resources, products across Beauty, Skin, and Hair "for all"

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Tone, Voice & Visual Branding

Warm & Approachable

Expert authority balanced with creative encouragement. Beauty as a playground, not a set of strict rules.

Visually Bold

Minimalist layouts, bold typography, high-resolution imagery centering diverse models with vibrant skin texture and pigment payoff.

Cross-Platform Consistency

Whether a 10-second Reel or a blog post, Fenty's personality feels cohesive—positioning the brand as both trendsetter and educator.

The blog's *Artistry Tips* page serves as an **"educational bridge"**—guiding users through shade-matching and application, making beauty accessible at every skill level.

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Instagram Analysis: Community & Creativity (Posts 1–5)

Post 1: Fan Art Tribute

Elevated a fan's oil painting for #NationalLipstickDay—**99,644 likes**. Celebrates real artists over AI, encouraging UGC.

Post 2: Sephora Giveaway

Mystery lip wardrobe giveaway with Sephora. Gamified content driving tags, follower acquisition, and retail partnership visibility.

Post 3: Lip Liner + Gloss Demo

Tutorial hybrid showcasing Trace'd Out + Gloss Bomb Oil. Highlights 8-hour wear and hydration, encouraging multi-SKU purchases.

Post 4: Plum-Inspired Look

Nature-as-muse visual metaphor. Sensory language ("juicy," "rich") creates memorable product recall through seasonal storytelling.

Post 5: Shimmery Red Gloss

Minimal caption, maximum intrigue. Ultra-close macro shots position gloss as a statement piece—driving shade-name requests and desire.

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Instagram Analysis: Education & Product (Posts 6–8)

Post 6: Bright Fix Powder Demo

Side-by-side "Set vs. Brighten" split-screen on deep skin tones. Real-time transformation builds trust and drives word-of-mouth.

Post 7: Powder Comparison Carousel

Invisimatte vs. Bright Fix mini buying guide. High "save" potential—mid-funnel content guiding purchase decisions.

Post 8: Under-Eye Brightening

Lavender Bright Fix + 150N Concealer tutorial. "Wakes up your face in a swipe"—practical beauty with color theory in action.

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Instagram Analysis: Diamond Bomb Campaign (Posts 9–15)

A **multi-stage teaser arc** building anticipation for the Diamond Bomb Collection launch.

1

Posts 9–11: Teasers

Static luxury shots, blurred silhouettes, and falling products in slow motion. "Can you guess what's coming?" drives comments and shares.

2

Posts 12–14: Build-Up

Macro sparkle close-ups and jewel-dust texture shots. Hypnotic visuals boost replay rates and bookmark saves.

3

Post 15: Full Reveal

"Drip yourself in diamonds from head to toe." New shades (Lavender Lu'r, Pink Ice, Trophy Wife), Ulta launch dates, and head-to-toe shimmer—campaign payoff.

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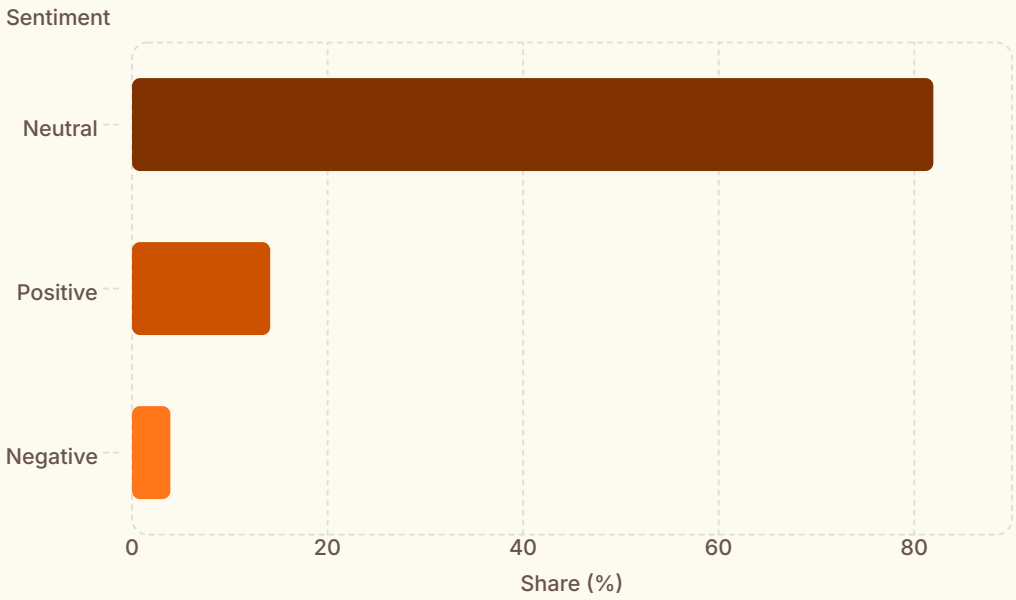
Cross-Platform Consistency & Sentiment

Platform Comparison

Element	Website/Blog	Instagram
Voice	Warm, educational	Playful, sensory
Visuals	Clean, minimal	High-glam, textured
Inclusivity	Systematic	Relational
Consistency	High	High

Sentiment Analysis (Jul 12 – Aug 10)



Only **3.92% negative** mentions. Twitter leads sources at 40.41%, Instagram at 30.46%, TikTok at 11.82%—reflecting strong visual-platform alignment.

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Recommendations: Shine Even Brighter

Enhance Education

Add virtual try-on tools and masterclass videos across Instagram, YouTube, and TikTok.

Amplify Real Stories

Launch #MyFentyJourney campaigns showcasing fans from all backgrounds.

Diversify Partnerships

Collaborate with artists, activists, and local micro-influencers globally.

Improve Accessibility

Add subtitles, readable pages, and alt-text; partner with inclusivity organizations.

Trend Responsiveness

Monitor social sentiment and join trending conversations quickly and authentically.

Personalize Experiences

Use shopping data for tailored recommendations and solicit customer input on future products.

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Conclusion

Fenty Beauty has not only disrupted but **redefined** the beauty industry. Since 2017, its 40+ shade foundation range and consistent cross-platform voice have built global trust.

Creativity

High-impact visuals and themed drops bring the brand to life.

Education

Shade guides and tutorials make makeup approachable for all.

Community

Real-time engagement and fan amplification make Fenty feel authentic.

Inclusivity is not a slogan—it's a guiding principle reflected in every campaign, product, and collaboration. By staying true to diversity, creativity, and self-expression, **Fenty Beauty is positioned to lead the industry into the future.**

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